

RFP Response: Apex Systems

Procurement Request: Enterprise Workflow Automation Platform

All information in this proposal is fictional and created for evaluation purposes.

1. Executive Summary

Apex Systems proposes a cloud-native workflow automation platform built on a microservices architecture with Kubernetes orchestration, event-driven messaging via Apache Kafka, and a React-based user portal.

We have carefully reviewed the requirement for 5,000 concurrent users, 99.9% uptime, and integration with SAP, Salesforce, and Okta SSO. Our solution directly addresses each with proven patterns from 12 prior enterprise deployments.

- Proposed approach: phased delivery with architecture runway in Sprint 0, ensuring scalability from day one.
- Key differentiator: reference architecture validated at 3x required throughput in load testing (15,000 concurrent users).

2. Proposed Solution & Technical Architecture

Architecture: Microservices (12 services) on Amazon EKS, PostgreSQL with read replicas, Redis cache, Kafka for async workflows. API gateway with rate limiting and OpenAPI 3.1 specs.

Integrations: Pre-built connectors for SAP S/4HANA (IDoc/BAPI), Salesforce (Bulk API 2.0), Okta (SAML/OIDC). Integration layer includes retry with exponential backoff, dead-letter queues, and idempotency keys.

Scalability: Horizontal pod autoscaling (HPA) on CPU and custom Kafka-lag metrics. Load test evidence: p95 latency 320ms at 15k concurrent users (report attached as Appendix A in full proposal).

- Technology fit: aligns with client's AWS-first policy; Infrastructure as Code with Terraform modules provided.
- Data migration: ETL pipeline with validation checksums; rollback runbook included.

3. Implementation Plan & Timeline

Moderate 24-week delivery across 4 phases: Foundation (6 wks), Core Workflows (8 wks), Integrations (6 wks), UAT & Hypercare (4 wks).

Phase	Duration	Key Milestones
Foundation	Wks 1-6	EKS cluster, CI/CD, auth integration
Core Workflows	Wks 7-14	8 priority workflows live in staging
Integrations	Wks 15-20	SAP/Salesforce/Okta certified
UAT & Hypercare	Wks 21-24	Cutover, 30-day hypercare

Team: 1 delivery lead, 2 architects, 4 backend, 2 frontend, 1 QA automation, 1 DevOps. RACI matrix provided.

Risk plan: integration dependency on client SAP team mitigated by mock services and 2-week buffer; risk register with 14 items and owners.

4. Commercials & Price Table

Item	Cost (USD)
Implementation (fixed fee)	\$485,000
Licenses Year 1 (5,000 users)	\$120,000
Managed hosting Year 1	\$60,000
Total Year 1	\$665,000

Assumptions: client provides AWS accounts and SAP sandbox by Week 2; change requests billed at \$185/hr; price valid 90 days.

Pricing is at the higher end, reflecting senior staffing and extended hypercare. Volume discount of 8% available for 3-year commitment.

Total cost of ownership (3 years): \$1.45M including support.

5. Security, Compliance & Risk Controls

Certifications: ISO 27001:2022, SOC 2 Type II (report available under NDA). Data encrypted AES-256 at rest, TLS 1.3 in transit.

Privacy: GDPR and CCPA compliant; data residency in us-east-1; DPA provided. PII tokenization in logs.

Auditability: immutable audit trail (WORM storage), SIEM forwarding to Splunk, quarterly pen tests by independent firm.

- Controls: least-privilege IAM, MFA enforced, secrets in AWS Secrets Manager with rotation.
- Business continuity: RPO 15 min, RTO 2 hrs, multi-AZ with tested failover.

6. Support Model, Experience & References

Support: 24/7 follow-the-sun, 99.9% SLA, 15-min P1 response. Dedicated TAM and quarterly business reviews.

Experience: 12 enterprise workflow deployments (2019-2025), including 2 Fortune 500 manufacturers. Average CSAT 4.6/5.

References: (1) Global logistics firm – 8,000 users, on-time delivery; (2) Financial services – SAP integration, contact available upon request.

Team certifications: 6x AWS Solutions Architect Pro, 3x CKA.